MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA AUTOMATION ENGINEER | TEST INFRASTRUCTURE & DEVOPS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling; owns GitLab CI pipelines and merge-request ephemeral environments for three product teams, reducing average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes. Hands-on with Docker, Helm, namespace-level Kubernetes, and personal k3s and GitOps projects, with an analytical, improvement-focused approach and clear technical documentation for onboarding; transitioning toward a full-time DevOps or platform engineering role.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal project), Argo CD

Containers & Linux: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; k3s homelab), Linux

Programming & Scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Testing & Quality: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Monitoring & Data: Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, PostgreSQL

Cloud learning: AWS (EC2 and S3 basics); Hetzner VPS

Other: Git, Ansible (basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wrocław *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments for the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%. Built a Python and PostgreSQL test-results pipeline and Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team; wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding; wrote an internal guide to how CI works, now used in onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wrocław *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Operate a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform in a personal account.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Delivered short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments with seeded data for merge requests, deployed using Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.

- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests in the environments.
- Automated environment removal after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled CI pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end testing into its own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet passed).